effortless enrichment is an entitlement associated with what is thought to be exceptional financial perspicacity and wisdom is not something that yields to legislative remedy.

Of the history and its compelling element of surprise there is no end, nor has it any defined geographical limits. In March 1990, Japanese stocks took a large and wholly unexpected dive—major stock indices on the Tokyo market went down by nearly a quarter. (Japanese ingenuity was, however, to come into play. A leading investment house concerned with Japan reported that "there was talk of changing the accounting rules, so that an institution that loses money in stocks can keep that fact confidential.") A *Washington Post* dispatch told of what had been previously expected: "It has been a matter of received wisdom…that the Japanese stock market, manipulated by the government and big investment houses, can only go up, generating funds for the nation's export assaults overseas."

In the last months, as this is written, word has come from Canada of collapse in the highly leveraged operations of Mr. Robert Campeau. These had put the continent's greatest retail houses under the burden of crushing debt. There was question as to whether they had enough money to buy the merchandise they needed to sell. Until the day of reckoning, few asked what this far-from-distinguished Canadian real estate operator, product of what has been called a roller-coaster career, could do for, say, Bloomingdale's. A sometime observer, New York retailing consultant Howard Davidowitz, said of him in *MacLean's* magazine that "he was the guy at the head of the table who was pounding his fist and yelling, 'Do the damn deal.' No one could have stopped him." Not a distinguished qualification. *Fortune* again captured the essence: "THE BIGGEST LOONIEST DEAL EVER. HOW THE WACKY ROBERT CAMPEAU AND HIS FEE-HUNGRY BANKERS CONCOCTED A HUGE TAKEOVER THAT PROMPTLY WENT BUST."